St Patrick's B.N.S, Drumcondra, Dublin 9, D09H008

Scoil Phádraig, Droim Conrach, Áth Cliath 9, D09H008

Telephone 018372714. Email: secretary@saintpats.ie

Admission Policy of Patrick's B.N.S

School Address: Millbourne Avenue, Drumcondra, Dublin 9, D09H008

Roll number: 11525a

School Patron: Archbishop of Dublin

1. Introduction

This Admission Policy complies with the requirements of the Education Act 1998, the Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 and the Equal Status Act 2000. In drafting this policy, the Board of Management (BoM) of the school has consulted with school staff, the school patron and with parents of children attending the school.

The policy was approved by the school patron on 2nd November,2020. It is published on the school's website and will be made available in hardcopy, on request, to any person who requests it.

The relevant dates and timelines for St. Patrick's B.N.S admission process are set out in the school's annual admission notice which is published annually on the school's website at least one week before the commencement of the admission process for the school year concerned.

This policy must be read in conjunction with the annual admission notice for the school year concerned.

The application form and admission statement is published on the school's website and will be made available in hardcopy on request to any person who requests it.

2. Characteristic spirit and general objectives of the school

St Patrick's B.N.S. is a Catholic all boys primary school with a Catholic ethos under the patronage of the Catholic Archbishop of Dublin.

"Catholic Ethos" in the context of a Catholic Primary School means the ethos and characteristic spirit of the Roman Catholic Church, which aims at promoting:

a) the full and harmonious development of all aspects of the person of the pupil, including the intellectual, physical, cultural, moral and spiritual aspects; and
b) a living relationship with God and with other people; and
c) a philosophy of life inspired by belief in God and in the life, death and resurrection of Jesus; and
d) the formation of the pupils in the Catholic faith

and which school provides religious education for the pupils in accordance with the doctrines, practices and traditions of the Roman Catholic Church, and/or such ethos and/or characteristic spirit as may be determined or interpreted from time to time by the Irish Episcopal Conference.

In accordance with S15(2) (b) of the Education Act 1998, the Board of Management of St Patrick's B.N.S shall uphold, and be accountable to the Patron for so upholding, the characteristic spirit of the school as determined by the cultural, educational , moral, religious, social, linguistic and spiritual values and traditions which inform and are characteristic of the objectives and conduct of the school.

Our Mission Statement: 'At St. Patrick's National School, we believe all children are entitled to develop their fullest potential - academically, socially, emotionally, physically, morally, spiritually and aesthetically, enabling each child to grow in confidence to participate in the wider community. We provide a happy caring and stimulating environment promoting self-esteem and confidence. We work in partnership with parents and the community in an atmosphere of mutual trust.'

3. Admission Statement

St Patrick's B.N.S. is a school whose objective is to provide education in an environment which promotes certain religious values and does not discriminate where it refuses to admit as a student a person who is not of the Catholic denomination, and it is proved that the refusal is essential to maintain the ethos of the school.

St Patrick's BNS will not discriminate in its admission of a pupil to the school on any of the following grounds:

(a) the gender of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned,

(b) the civil status of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned,

(c) the family status of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil

concerned

(d) the sexual orientation of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil

concerned,

(e) the religion of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned,

(f) a disability of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned,

(g) the race of the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned,

(h) that the pupil or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned is of the Traveller Community, or

(i) that the pupil ,or the applicant in respect of the pupil concerned, has special educational needs

As per section 61 (3) of the Education Act 1998, 'civil status ground', 'disability ground', 'discriminate', 'family status ground', 'gender ground', 'ground of race', 'religion ground', 'sexual orientation ground' and 'Traveller community ground' shall be construed in accordance with section 3 of the Equal Status Act 2000.

St. Patrick's B.N.S is an all-boys school. The school does not discriminate where it refuses to admit a girl applying for admission to mainstream classes in this school.

St. Patrick's is a school which has established two Specific Speech and Language Disorder (S.S.L.D) classes, with the approval of the Minister for Education and Skills, which provides an education exclusively for boys and girls from senior infants to 6th class with Developmental Language Disorder; and may refuse to admit to the class a pupil who does not have the category of needs specified. The enrolment procedure for the Specific Speech and Language Disorder (S.S.L.D) class has been added as Appendix 5 to this policy.

4. Categories of Special Educational Needs catered for in the school/special class

St. Patrick's B.N.S with the approval of the Minister for Education and Skills, has established two classes to provide an education exclusively for boys and girls from senior infants to 6th class, with Developmental Language Disorder (DLD).

Please see appendix 5 for enrolment criteria for the DLS classes.

St Patrick's BNS's mainstream classes are inclusive of pupils with additional needs.

5. Admission of Students

St Patrick's BNS is a Catholic school and may refuse to admit as a student a person who is not of the Catholic denomination where it is proved that the refusal is essential to maintain the ethos of the school.

This school shall admit each student seeking admission except where –

a) the school is oversubscribed (please see section 6 below for further details)

b) a parent of a student, when required by the principal in accordance with section 23(4)

of the Education (Welfare) Act 2000, fails to confirm in writing that the Code of Behaviour of the school is acceptable to him or her and that he or she shall make all reasonable efforts to ensure compliance with such code by the student.

St Patrick's B.N.S provides education exclusively for boys, with the exception of the S.S.L.D classes, which provide education for boys and girls.

The SSLD classes attached to St Patrick's B.N.S provide an education exclusively for pupils from senior infants to 6th class with Developmental Language Disorder and the school may refuse admission to this class, where the student concerned does not have the specified category of special educational needs provided for in this class.

6. Oversubscription

In the event that the school is oversubscribed, the school will, when deciding on applications for admission, apply the following selection criteria in the order listed below to those applications that are received within the timeline for receipt of applications as set out in the school's annual admission notice:

a) Brothers of boys already attending St. Patrick's B.N.S, including step-brothers and adoptive/foster brothers

b) Boys ordinarily resident in the geographical area encompassed in the Drumcondra

boundary map (which includes the parish of Corpus Christi) in Appendix 1, with priority to the oldest on date of commencement of the school year (as per birth cert)

c) Sons of current staff members of St. Patrick's B.N.S, with priority to the oldest.
d) Boys ordinarily resident in the adjacent Drumcondra area, as outlined in the boundary map in Appendix 2, with priority to the oldest on date of commencement of the school year (as per birth cert)
e) Boys ordinarily resident in the geographical area encompassed in the boundary map in Appendix 3 with priority to the oldest on the date of commencement of the school year (as per birth cert)
f) All other applicants (Priority to the oldest child)

In the event that there are two or more students tied for a place or places in any of the selection criteria categories above (the number of applicants exceeds the number of remaining places), the following arrangements will apply:

In the event of two or more students being tied for a place, the oldest student will be given priority. If two applicants have the same date of birth, then a lottery will apply with an independent party present. .

7. What will not be considered or taken into account

In accordance with section 62(7)(e) of the Education Act, the school will not consider or take into account any of the following in deciding on applications for admission or when placing a student on a waiting list for admission to the school:

a) A pupil's prior attendance at a pre- school or pre-school service, including naíonraí;
b) The payment of fees or contributions (howsoever described) to the school;
c) A pupil's academic ability, skills or aptitude; other than in relation to:
admission to the S.S.L.D Class insofar as it is necessary in order to ascertain whether or not the pupil has the category of special educational needs concerned
d) The occupation, financial status, academic ability, skills or aptitude of a pupil's parents;
e) A requirement that a pupil, or his or her parents, attend an interview, open day or other meeting as a condition of admission;

f) A pupil's connection to the school by virtue of a member of his or her family attending or having previously attended the school, other than in the case of the siblings/step siblings of a pupil attending the school.
g) The date and time on which an application for admission was received by the school.

This is subject to the application being received at any time during the period specified for receiving applications set out in the annual admission notice of the school for the school year concerned.

This is also subject to the school making offers based on existing waiting lists (up until 31st January 2025 only.)

8. Decisions on applications

All decisions on applications for admission to St Patrick's B.N.S will be based on the following:

- Our school's admission policy
- The school's annual admission notice (where applicable)
- The information provided by the applicant in the school's official application form received during the period specified in our annual admission notice for receiving applications, which may be subject to verification.

(Please see section 15 below in relation to applications received outside of the admissions period and section 16 below in relation to applications for places in years other than the intake group.)

Selection criteria that are not included in our school admission policy will not be used to make a decision on an application for a place in our school.

9. Notifying applicants of decisions

Applicants will be informed in writing as to the decision of the school, within the timeline outlined in the annual admissions notice.

If a pupil is not offered a place in our school, the reasons why they were not offered a place will be communicated in writing to the applicant, including, where applicable, details of the pupil's ranking against the selection criteria and details of the pupil's place on the waiting list for the school year concerned.

Applicants will be informed of the right to seek a review/right of appeal of the school's decision (see section 18 below for further details).

10. Acceptance of an offer of a place by an applicant

In accepting an offer of admission from St. Patrick's B.N.S, you must indicate—

(i) whether or not you have accepted an offer of admission for another school or schools. If you have accepted such an offer, you must also provide details of the offer or offers concerned and

(ii) whether or not you have applied for and awaiting confirmation of an offer of admission from another school or schools, and if so, you must provide details of the other school or schools concerned.

11. Circumstances in which offers may not be made or may be withdrawn

An offer of admission may not be made or may be withdrawn by St Patrick's B.N.S where—

(i) it is established that information contained in the application is false or misleading.

(ii) an applicant fails to confirm acceptance of an offer of admission on or before the

date set out in the annual admission notice of the school.

(iii) the parent of a pupil when required by the principal in accordance with section 23(4)

of the Education (Welfare) Act 2000, fails to confirm in writing that the Code of Behaviour of the school is acceptable to him or her and that he or she shall make all reasonable efforts to ensure compliance with such code by the student; or

(iv) an applicant has failed to comply with the requirements of 'acceptance of an offer'

as set out in section 10 above.

12.Sharing of Data with other schools

Applicants should be aware that section 66(6) of the Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 allows for the sharing of certain information between schools in order to facilitate the efficient admission of pupils.

Section 66 (6) allows a school to provide a patron or another board of management with a list of the pupils in relation to whom

1) an application for admission to the school has been received.

2) an offer of admission to the school has been made,

or

3) an offer of admission to the school has been accepted.

The list may include any or all of the following:

1) The date on which an application for admission was received by the school;

2) the date on which an offer of admission was made by the school;

3) the date on which an offer of admission was accepted by the applicant;

4) a pupil's personal details including his name , address, date of birth and personal public services number (within the meaning of section 262 of the Social Welfare Consolidation Act 2005)

13. Waiting list in the event of oversubscription

In the event of there being more applications to the school year concerned than places available, a waiting list of pupils whose applications for admission to St. Patrick's were unsuccessful due to the school being oversubscribed will be compiled and will remain valid for the school year in which admission is being sought.

Placement on the waiting list of St. Patrick's is in the order of priority assigned to the pupils' applications after the school has applied the selection criteria in accordance with this admission policy.

Applicants whose applications are received after the closing date, outlined in the Annual Admissions Notice, will be placed at the end of the waiting list in order of the date of receipt of the application.

Offers of any subsequent places that become available for and during the school year in relation to which admission is being sought will be made to those pupils on the waiting list, in accordance with the order of priority in relation to which the pupils have been placed on the list.

14. Late Applications

All applications for admission received after the closing date as outlined in the annual admission notice will be considered and decided upon in accordance with our school's admissions policy, the Education Admissions to School Act 2018 and any regulations made under that Act.

Late applicants will be notified of the decision in respect of their application no later than three weeks after the date on which the school received the application. Late applicants will be offered

a place if there is a place available. In the event that there is no place available, the name of the applicant will be added to the waiting list as set out in Section 13.

15. Procedures for admission of students to other years (not Junior infants)

The procedures of the school in relation to the admission of pupils who are not already admitted to the school to classes or years other than the school's intake group are as follows:

With regard to the enrolment of children at other than initial enrolment in Junior Infants:

- The decision of how many children to enrol in a year is a function of the BOM. The BOM reserves the right to determine the maximum number of children enrolled and the numbers enrolled in each separate classroom as per the criteria previously listed above.
- The selection criteria for admission as outlined in this policy will be applied to those applications that are received within the timeline for receipt of applications as set out in the school's annual admission notice for other year groups.
- Applicants whose applications are received after the closing date, outlined in the Annual Admissions Notice for other year groups, will be placed at the end of the waiting list in order of the date of receipt of the application.
- Offers of any subsequent places that become available for and during the school year in relation to which admission is being sought will be made to those pupils on the waiting list, in accordance with the order of priority in relation to which the pupils have been placed on the list.
- Should there be space in the required class, having applied the criteria for enrolment as outlined in this policy, the pupil shall be enrolled once all necessary paperwork is provided.

- Where multiple applications are received for a place in a given class the admission criteria will apply as with an application for infant enrolment , as set out in this policy.
- In the event of no places being available for a given year, an application will be retained and will be considered 'live' for that school year only.

16. Declaration in relation to the non-charging of fees

The Board of St Patrick's B.N.S or any persons acting on its behalf will not charge fees for or seek payment or contributions (howsoever described) as a condition of-

(a) an application for admission of a student to the school, or

(b) the admission or continued enrolment of a student in the school.

17. Arrangements regarding students not attending religious instruction

The following are the school's arrangements for pupils, where the parents have requested that the student attend the school without attending religious instruction in the school. These arrangements will not result in a reduction in the school day of such students:

A written request should be made to the Principal. A meeting will then be arranged with the parent(s) to discuss how the request may be accommodated by the school.

18. Reviews/appeals

Review of decisions by the Board of Management

The parent of the pupil, may request the Board to review a decision to refuse admission. Such requests must be made in accordance with Section 29C of the Education Act 1998.

The timeline within which such a review must be requested and the other requirements applicable to such reviews are set out in the procedures determined by the Minister under section 29B of the Education Act 1998 which are published on the website of the Department of Education and Skills.

The Board will conduct such reviews in accordance with the requirements of the procedures determined under Section 29B and with section 29C of the Education Act 1998.

Note: Where an applicant has been refused admission due to the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **must request a review** of that decision by the Board of management prior to making an appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998.

Where an applicant has been refused admission due to a reason other than the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **may request a review** of that decision by the board of management prior to making an appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998.

Right of appeal

Under Section 29 of the Education Act 1998, the parent of the student, may appeal a decision of this school to refuse admission.

An appeal may be made under Section 29 (1)(c)(i) of the Education Act 1998 where the refusal to admit was due to the school being oversubscribed.

An appeal may be made under Section 29 (1)(c)(ii) of the Education Act 1998 where the refusal to admit was due a reason other than the school being oversubscribed.

Where an applicant has been refused admission due to the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **must request a review** of that decision by the board of management **prior to making an appeal** under section 29 of the Education Act 1998. (see Review of decisions by the Board of Management)

Where an applicant has been refused admission due to a reason other than the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **may request a review** of that decision by the board of management prior to making an appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998. (see Review of decisions by the Board of Management)

Appeals under Section 29 of the Education Act 1998 will be considered and determined by an independent appeals committee appointed by the Minister for Education and Skills.

The timeline within which such an appeal must be made and the other requirements applicable to such appeals are set out in the procedures determined by the Minister under section 29B of the Education Act 1998 which are published on the website of the Department of Education and Skills.

Signed:





Ms. Natasha Bassett

(Principal)

Prof. Anne Looney

(Chairperson of Board of Management)

Appendices

Appendix 1: Catchment Area , Map 1, reviewed 2021

Appendix 2: Catchment Area , Map 2, reviewed 2021

Appendix 3: Catchment Area , Map 3, reviewed 2021

Appendix 4: Template of Annual Admission Statement

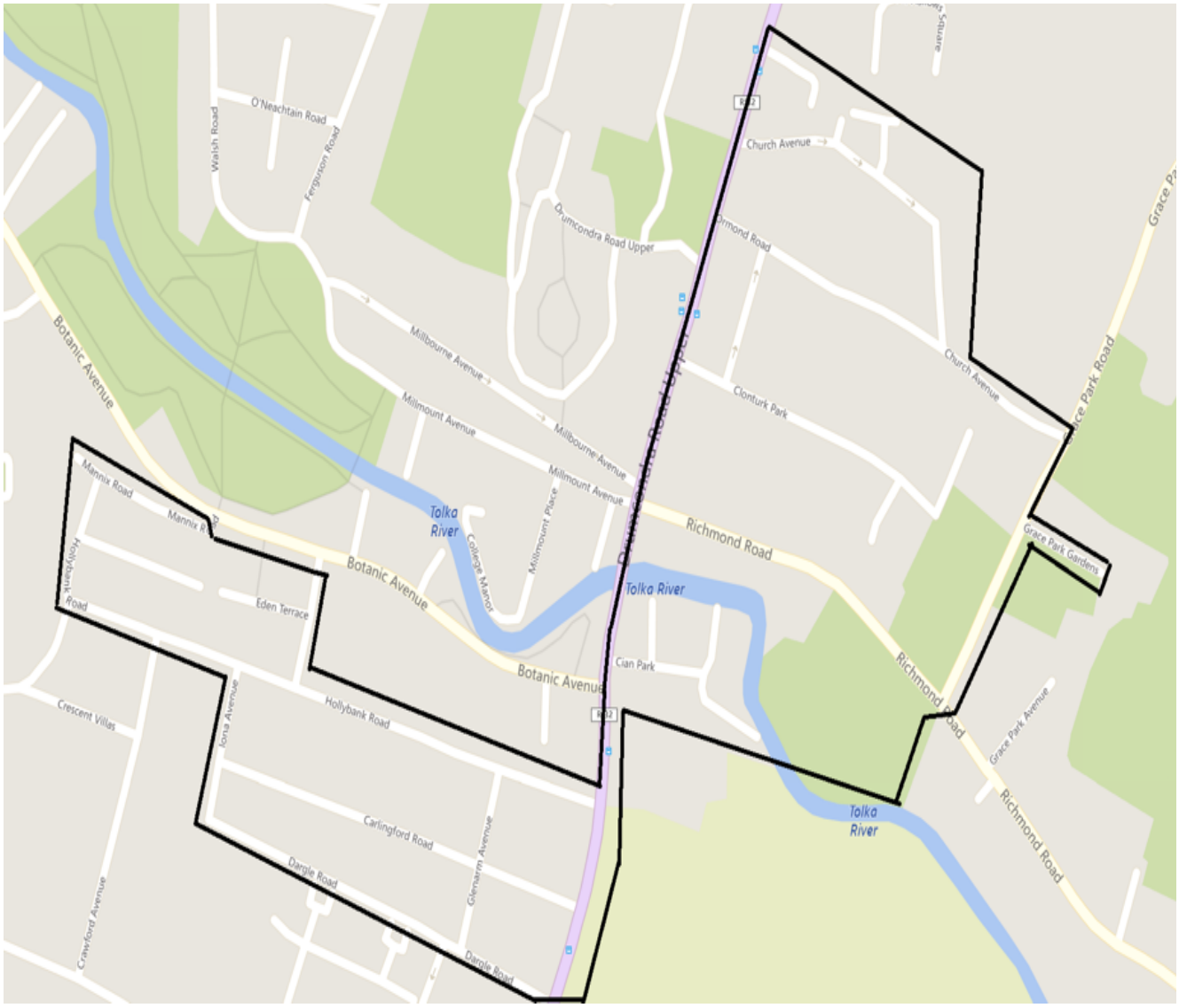
Appendix 6: Specific Speech and Language (S.S.L.D) Class, Enrolment Policy

Appendix 6: Standard Application Form

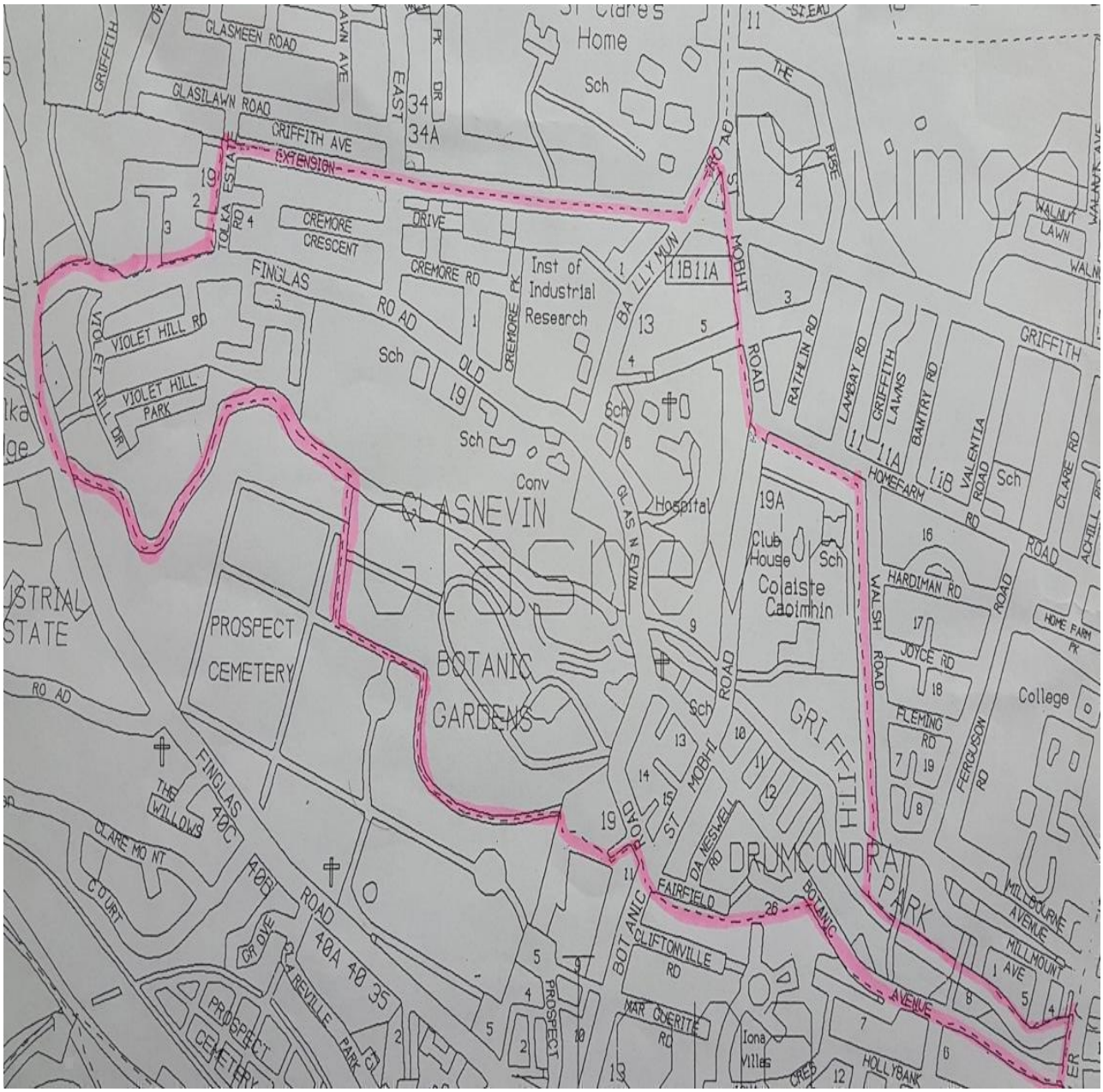
Appendix 1: Catchment Area, Map 1, reviewed Sept 2021



Appendix 2: Catchment Area Map 2, reviewed Sept 2021



Appendix 3: Catchment Area Map 3, Reviewed Sept 2021



Appendix 4:

St Patrick's B.N.S

ANNUAL ADMISSION NOTICE

in respect of admissions to the 20XX/20XX school year

Admission Policy and Application Form

A copy of the school's **Admission Policy** and the **Application Form for Admission** for the [insert school year] is available as follows: –

To download at: www.saintpats.ie

On request: By emailing secretary@saintpats.ie. or writing to : The Principal, St. Patrick's B.N.S, Millbourne Avenue, Drumcondra, Dublin D09H008

PART I - Admissions to the [insert school year concerned] school year

Application and Decision Dates for admission to [insert school year concerned]

The following are the dates applicable for admission to Junior Infants

The school will commence accepting applications for admission on	
The school shall cease accepting applications for admission on	
The date by which applicants will be notified of the decision on their application is	
The period within which applicants must confirm acceptance of an offer of admission is	

Note: the school will consider and issue decisions on late applications in accordance with the school's admission policy.

Specific Speech and Language (S.S.L.D) Class Application and Decision Dates for admission to [insert school year concerned]

The following are the dates applicable for admission to the school's Language Class which caters for children with Developmental Language Disorder (D.L.D] -

The school will commence accepting applications for admission to the special class on	
The school shall cease accepting applications for admission to the special class on	
The date by which applicants will be notified of the decision on their application for admission to the special class is	
The period within which applicants must confirm acceptance of an offer of admission is	

***Failure to accept an offer within the prescribed period above may result in the offer being withdrawn**

Number of places being made available in [insert school year concerned

The number of places being made available in junior infants/first year(delete as appropriate) is	
The number of residential places is (boarding schools only)	
The number of non-residential places is (boarding schools only)	
The number of places being made available in the special class* catering for children with Developmental Language Disorder (D.L.D) is	

(***Note:** If school has a number of classes that cater for different categories of SEN, details of the numbers of places for each SEN class must be provided)

The following text applies only to schools that made offers of school places in respect of the 2021/22 school year and those offers that were accepted prior to 1 February 2020. It should be deleted in all other cases.

[School Name] has made offers of school placement which have been accepted prior to the commencement of Section 62 of the Education (Admission to Schools) 2018 on 1 February 2020, the number of those places offered and accepted for [junior infants/ first year intake group for 20XX/20XX] is:

PART 2 - Admissions to the [insert previous school year] school year

(This section should only be completed if your school intake group/ special class was oversubscribed in the previous school year)

Information regarding the admission process for the Intake Group for [Junior Infants/Special Class for the (XXXX) school year

In respect of the [insert school year prior to that to which the admission notice applies] school year, the total number of applications for admission received by the school was_____

Breakdown of places allocated for the xx/xx school year:	
Number of places available:	
Number of applications received:	
Number of Offers made and accepted under each criteria:	A description of each criterion used and the number of places offered and accepted under that criterion must be entered here. Example, as follows: Criterion One: Applicants living in the catchment area – __ places offered, __ places accepted. Criterion Two: Applicants with siblings attending the school – places offered, __ places accepted.
Total number of offers made	
Number of names placed on waiting list for the school year concerned.	

Appendix 5

St Patrick's B.N.S, Drumcondra, Dublin 9, D09H008

Scoil Phádraig, Droim Conrach, Áth Cliath 9

Telephone 018372714 email: secretary@saintpats.ie

Specific Speech and Language Disorder (SSLD) Classes Enrolment/Admissions Policy

September 2021

Special note in relation to applications made in the school year 2021/22, for September 2022

Due to the special circumstances in relation to the impact of the Covid-19 pandemic on the assessment of pupils, the following three amendments to the eligibility/local referral criteria will apply for applications made in 2021/2022 , for enrolment in the academic year 2022/23. Please refer to the section on Eligibility /Local criteria for the full list of criteria.

In relation to the Speech and Language criteria:

Change 1

A **child must have attended a minimum of 6 individual therapy sessions within 9 months of the application deadline (i.e. from June 2021 onwards). These therapy sessions can be online tele practice sessions, clinic based or a combination of both.**

Change 2

Speech & Language Assessments must have been carried out within 6 months of the application deadline (i.e. from 1st September onwards). Standardised assessments should be used and all subtest and core/index scores should be reported which places performance in one or more of the main areas of speech and language development at two standard deviations or more below the mean or at a generally equivalent level. SLTs are required to supplement this with previous assessment results/findings (from the past two years) that demonstrate the clinical markers for DLD and support the clinical diagnosis of DLD.

Introduction

This policy is set out in accordance with the provisions of the Education Act, 1998, the Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 and the Department of Education and Skills Circular 0038/2007. The Board of Management trusts that by doing so, parents/guardians will be assisted in relation to enrolment matters and procedures for the Specific Speech and Language Disorder (SSLD) Classes in St Patrick's BNS. Furthermore, the Board of Management and the Principal will be happy to clarify any further matters arising from the policy.

Developmental Language Disorder

Developmental Language Disorder (DLD) means that a child has significant, on-going difficulties understanding and/or using spoken language, in all the languages he/she uses. DLD was previously known as Specific Speech and Language Impairment (SSLI) or Specific Language Impairment (SLI). In Ireland the new term DLD has been adopted by the Irish Association of Speech and Language Therapists (IASLT) in line with international consensus. Specific Speech and Language Disorder (SSLD) is the term which the Department of Education and Skills (DES) in Ireland continues to use.

IASLT in its 2017 Position Paper and Guidance Document *Supporting Children with DLD in Ireland* explain that DLD describes "children likely to have language problems enduring into middle childhood and beyond, with a significant impact on everyday social interactions and/or educational progress". For this group of children, their language disorder is not caused by other medical conditions, such as, hearing loss, physical impairment, Autism, severe learning difficulties or brain injuries. The characteristics of children with DLD include speech, language and communication difficulties affecting the following areas: phonology, syntax, semantics, word finding, pragmatics/language use and verbal learning and memory. Children with DLD can also have other difficulties (e.g. attention, motor, literacy, and speech or behaviour difficulties).

One option within the clinical care pathway for provision of a Speech & Language Therapy (SLT) service to children with DLD is by means of enrolment within a specific class. These classes, termed SSLD (Specific Speech & Language Disorder) classes by the DES offer intensive speech & language therapy which is integrated with the child's academic development

How the SSLD Classes are organised

For school aged children with DLD in Ireland an arrangement exists between the Department of Education and Skills (DES) and Department of Health & Children (DOHC)/Health Services Executive (HSE) to provide school-based SLT to children through attendance at an SSLD class.

- St. Patrick's B.N.S. has two SSLD Classes, which cater for the needs of children with DLD, from Senior Infants upwards.
- St. Patrick's BNS is a boys' school however girls can attend the SSLD classes.
- The maximum enrolment in each class is in line with the Department regulations (i.e. 7 children per class) to allow for intensive educational and SLT programmes suited to the children's needs.
- Each class is staffed by a full time teacher, and has designated time assigned to it by a speech and language therapist. Each class also has an allocation of a Special Needs Assistant (SNA).
- SLT is provided by arrangement with the DoHC/HSE and the therapy delivery is integrated with the educational provision. At the time of revising this policy each class is receiving 2.5 days of SLT provision per week.
- Eligible pupils may spend up to a maximum of two years in the SSLD class.
- Pupils follow the regular primary school curriculum to the level at which they can access it. They receive intensive individual and group therapy with the Speech and Language Therapist (SLT). The teacher and SLT work closely together to help promote each child's speech, language and communication skills in a programme which is integrated into the educational setting.
- The pupils in the SSLD Class are integrated with their peers from mainstream classes for some subjects, during break times and for school activities such as concerts/ school tours.

Eligibility

The Common Advisory Admissions Committee (CAAC) under the direction of both the Board of Management (BOM) of St. Patrick's National School and the Board of Management of Powerstown ETNS has the final decision in the enrolment of children in the SSLD Classes (subject to allowable appeals). The following eligibility criteria must be met by each applicant:

Criteria 1: Department of Education and Skills Criteria

The Department of Education has outlined the criteria for enrolment in a (SSLD) DLD Class. These include exclusionary and discrepancy criteria in relation to language and IQ scores in children with DLD. In order to be described as having a Developmental Language Disorder (DLD) as per the Department of Education in Ireland pupils should meet each of the following criteria (from the DE Circular 38/07):

I. Assessment by a psychologist on a standardised test of intelligence, which places non-verbal, or performance ability within the average range or above (i.e. non-verbal IQ of 90, or above).

II. Assessment on a standardised test of speech and/or language development by a speech and language therapist which places performance in one or more of the main areas of speech and language development at two standard deviations or more below the mean or at a generally equivalent level (i.e. at or below a standard score of 70).

III. The pupils' difficulties are not attributable to hearing impairment, the hearing threshold for the speech related frequencies should be 40dB

IV. Emotional or behavioural disorders or a physical disability are not considered to be primary causes.

Criteria 2: Local Criteria

1. The child must live within the designated catchment area at the time of referral (i.e. HSE areas Dublin North Central and North West Dublin).

11. At the time of application a child must currently be enrolled in Junior Infants, Senior Infants, 1st, 2nd, 3rd , 4 th or 5th class (or equivalent).

111. A child must have attended a minimum of 6 individual therapy sessions within 9 months of the application deadline (i.e. from June 2021 onwards). These therapy sessions can be online via Teletherapy sessions, clinic based or a combination of both.

V1. Speech & Language Assessments must have been carried out within 6 months of the application deadline (i.e. from 1st September onwards). Standardised assessments should be used and all subtest and core/index scores should be reported which places performance in one or more of the main areas of speech and language development at two standard deviations or more below the mean or at a generally equivalent level. SLTs are required to supplement this with previous assessment results/findings (from the past two years) that demonstrate the clinical markers for DLD and support the clinical diagnosis of DLD.

V11. An up to date psychology report, within 3 years of referral; which includes the results of a comprehensive assessment of intellectual ability, including non-verbal index/factor scores and subtest results.

V111. An up to date speech and language therapy report (written within three months of the closing date of 1st March) confirming a diagnosis of Developmental Language Disorder (DLD) and outlining the need for the placement in the SSLD class.

Criteria 3: Priority Rating Scale

- The Priority Rating Scale for SSLD Class Admissions is used during the Common Advisory Admissions Committee Meeting.
- This priority rating scale (PRS) was adapted from the New Brunswick Health and Community Services PRS and was developed in 1997. The Special Interest Group of SLTs in DLD in Ireland has adapted the New Brunswick PRS for application to SSLD class admissions procedure. The rating scale has three sections: impact of the presenting problem (academic, social, emotional), predicted outcome of intervention (e.g. history and success of previous intervention) and impact of service delay. Information from the reports received on each applicant is used in the completion of this rating scale. Each child is then given an overall priority rating that is high, medium or low.

- All children are then listed in order of their priority. Those children at the top of the priority list will be recommended for places in the class for the academic year commencing in September of that year.
- Where the number of children referred exceeds the number of places available, names are placed on a prioritised waiting list for that admission year. This list of both children offered SSLD class places and children on a prioritised waiting list will be ratified by the BOM and noted in the BOM minutes.

Criteria 4: Age and Geography

- Once children meet the DES and local eligibility criteria (outlined above) they are listed in order of priority of need using the Priority Rating Scale (detailed above).
- The Common Advisory Admissions Committee will then proceed to the enrolment stage. Children may be offered a place in Powerstown Educate Together NS (PETNS) or St. Patrick's BNS depending on age-appropriate available places in St. Patrick's and Powerstown ETNS SSLD classes.
- The Common Advisory Admissions Committee will endeavour, where possible, to offer the prioritised children an available place in the closest SSLD class to their home address. This is dependent on available places in the SSLD class.

Admissions to the SSLD Classes under spare capacity provision

The DES has outlined (in circular 0083/2007) a spare capacity provision for SSLD class admissions. This applies in instances where there is spare capacity in a SSLD class because of insufficient eligible children, the board of management (BOM) may offer a place to a maximum of two pupils who do not meet the eligibility criteria above but who could benefit from enrolment in the class for one year on a concessionary basis. Such placements must be supported by the recommendation of a speech and language therapist and/or psychologist. The question of the continued enrolment of these pupils for a second year can only be considered once all of the eligible pupils have been accommodated. The National Council for Special Education through the local Special Education Needs Organiser (SENO) will monitor such situations

The Board of Management (BOM) of St Patrick's BNS has the final decision in the enrolment of children in the SSLD Classes.

Referral Procedure

Once a diagnosis of DLD is established by the referring SLT a child may be referred for SSLD class placement. Children are referred to the class by a Speech and Language Therapist and/or Psychologist. These professionals will recommend

the SSLD Class if they feel it is appropriate to meet the child's needs. Either the SLT or Psychologist must coordinate the referral.

In order for a child to be considered for a place in the classes, six copies of each of the documents listed below are required. The referral should be sent to the Language Classes Applications Office for St. Patrick's BNS and Powerstown ETNS, c/o St. Patrick's Boys National School, Drumcondra, Dublin 9.

The closing date for referrals is 1st March each year (or whereby the 1st falls on a weekend/school closure day the closest Friday to the 1st of March).

All and any professional reports in support of an application must be received by this date. Any reports which are received following this date, will not be considered by the Common Advisory Admissions Committee for the year in question. (However they may form part of an application for the following year).

Please note that all applications are considered by the Common Advisory Admissions Committee for both schools, which combines Dublin North City & County Community Healthcare**,** Dublin North Central & North West Dublin areas.

Children may be offered a place in Powerstown ETNS or St. Patrick's N.S. (not both).

Completion of this application does not guarantee or constitute an offer of a place in any of the SSLD classes.

<u>Reports Required for Referral to SSLD Classes in St Patrick's National School</u>

- A completed 'Referral and consent form for Language Classes'. This includes a parental consent section and a Social, Emotional and Behavioural Rating Scale to be completed by the child's parents with the assistance of the SLT.
- An up to date psychology report (within 3 years of referral) which includes the results of a comprehensive assessment of intellectual ability, including non-verbal index/factor scores and subtest results.
- A school report which provides information on the impact of the child's language disorder on his/her educational progress and social/emotional development. A specific report form for primary school children is provided and should be used. Please refer to the instructions on the top of the form prior to completion. A Social, Emotional and Behavioural Rating scale for teachers to complete is included in the primary school report form.
- An up to date speech and language therapy report (written within three months of the closing date of 1st March) confirming a diagnosis of Developmental Language Disorder (DLD) and outlining the need for the placement in the SSLD class.

Following receipt of a referral, parents/guardians and the referral source will receive a letter from the SSLD Classes Applications Office. This will acknowledge that the referral has been received and give the Common Advisory Admissions Committee meeting date. It will also give an approximate date as to when the parents/referral sources will be informed of the committee's decision.

The SSLD Classes Application Office collates the incoming referrals. Copies of the reports for each referral will be distributed to all members of the Common Advisory Admissions Committee as soon as possible after the closing date for referrals.

Common Advisory Admissions Committee (CAAC)

The Common Advisory Admissions Committee (CAAC) is a multi-agency committee made up of a group of professionals working for either the DES or the HSE who decide which referrals are selected for places in the SSLD classes. The CAAC is generally comprised of the following: School Principals of Powerstown ETNS and St. Patrick's N.S, SSLD class teachers, SSLD Class SLTs, SLT manager (HSE), Principal Psychologist Manager (HSE) and NEPS Psychologist.

The AAC discusses the clinical and educational needs of the applicants for SSLD Class placement based on the information provided in the reports outlined above. It prioritises the applicants for allocation to the available places in the SSLD Class.

Common Advisory Admissions Committee Meeting.

This meeting usually takes place in April each year. This is the meeting at which the CAAC makes recommendations on the allocation of places in the SSLD classes. This will include discussion regarding which current pupils will stay in the class for a further year, and which pupils will return to their local primary schools.

The number of new places becoming available each year will vary depending on the number of children discharged from the class. The maximum number of places available at any one time is in line with DES regulations.

Initially the CAAC checks that each child meets the DES and local criteria outlined above. Children who do not meet the DES criteria or the local criteria are not considered further for a place in the SSLD Classes (subject to spare capacity provision explained on page 4 of this policy). The Common Advisory Admissions Committee then applies the Priority Rating Scale, which considers a number of criteria (as detailed above), for each child who meets the DES and local criteria.

- All children are then listed in order of their priority.
- Those children at the top of the priority list will be recommended for places in the class for the academic year commencing in September of that year.
- Where the number of children referred exceeds the number of places available, names are placed on a prioritised waiting list for that admission year.
- This list of both children offered SSLD class places and children on a prioritised waiting list will be ratified by the BOM and noted in the BOM minutes.

- The CAAC will then proceed to the enrolment stage. Children may be offered a place in PETNS or St. Patrick's depending on age-appropriate available places in St. Patrick's SSLD Classes and PETNS Junior SSLD Class.

- The Advisory Selection committee will endeavour, where possible, to offer the child an available place in the closest SSLD class to their home address. This is dependent on available places in the SSLD class.

The recommendations of the CAAC are conveyed in writing to all the parents and referral sources. This letter is signed by the School Principals on behalf of the BOMs (of both schools).

Pupils who are offered a place

In the letters to parents/guardians of children who are being offered a place in the SSLD Class, parents are asked to contact the SLT in the relevant SSLD Class by telephone within one week (5 working days) of receipt of the letter offering them a place to confirm that they are interested in the place.

These parents/guardians are invited to attend an information meeting in the school before confirming that they will accept this place.

- The parents/guardians and children meet with the SSLD class teacher, SLT and school Principal at this meeting.
- Parents/guardians are asked to fill out the School Enrolment form at the end of the group meeting if they are happy to proceed with enrolment.
- Parents/guardians are asked to fill out School Transport and other DES forms if they are happy to proceed with enrolment.
- All pupils are accepted on the understanding that they and their parents/guardians fully accept the school's Code of Discipline, and all other school policies (e.g. Healthy Eating, Child Protection Policy, Homework Policy) currently in place or which may be drawn up from time to time by the school's staff and/or Board of Management.

Where an offer of a place is declined, the next child on the prioritised waiting list will be offered a place.

Pupils who are not offered a place

In letters to parents/guardians of children who are not offered places, parents/guardians are advised that they can appeal under Section 7 of the Education (Admissions to Schools) Act 2018. Circular 0069/2020 details the new arrangements and procedures for appeals under section 29 of the Education Act, 1998 effective from 12 November 2020 onwards, available here.

- Procedures for appeals in relation to refusal to admit a student to a school, where the decision to refuse admission is due to the school being oversubscribed, available here
- FAQs for appeals in relation to refusal to admit a student due to the school being oversubscribed, available here.

- Section 29 appeal application form for an appeal against refusal to admit due to the school being oversubscribed , is available here

Referrals are not carried forward from one year to the next and children who are unsuccessful in securing places in the SSLD classes must be referred again if they are to be considered for the following year.

All referral reports except originals will be shredded by SSLD Class SLT. Each child's original referral documents will be stored in the child's SLT file in the case of children who attend the SSLD class following the CAAC meeting. For children who are not offered a place and who are placed on the waiting list, the original referral documents will be stored in a secure filing cabinet in SSLD SLT's clinic room.

Spare capacity

In the event of spare capacity in the SSLD classes the Common Advisory Admissions Committee (in consultation with the BoM) will adhere to the relevant clauses in Circular 0038/2007.

Oversubscription:

If the DLD classes are oversubscribed the Common Advisory Admissions Committee will apply the following selection criteria to pupils. These will be applied in the order listed below to applications received within the timeline as set out in the school's annual admission notice for the DLD class.

Priority Category 1: Children who are deemed eligible, meet all criteria and are at the top of the priority list, as decided by the Common Advisory Admissions Committee using the Brunswick Priority Rating Scale.

Priority Category 2: In the event of spare capacity in the DLD classes the Common Advisory Admissions Committee (in consultation with the BOM) will adhere to the relevant clauses in Circular 0038/2007. In the event that there are two or more students tied for a place or places in any of the selection criteria categories above (the number of applicants exceeds the number of remaining places), places will be offered or added to a waiting list by way of a lottery of completed applications.

Inclusion of pupils with SSLD

All the children in the SSLD Classes are integrated with other pupils during playtime, during school trips and outings. The SSLD Class pupils also integrate with mainstream classes for a variety of subjects at different times. In so far as possible the child's individual and group SLT sessions are timetabled so as not to clash with the timetable for pupils integrating with their peers but this is not always possible. Note : During the Covid 19 pandemic the level of integration with other mainstream classes is dependent on current restrictions.

Pupils in the SSLD Class will be part of the normal day to day experiences, determined by the reality of school life, and the existing customs and practices. Every child in the school is bound by school policies, both those in existence and those developed from time to time by the staff and/or Board of Management. The school cannot offer any

additional tuition, support and supervision beyond that which is offered to any other pupil in the school, at times other than when the school is in operation during the normal school year.

Pupils in the SSLD Classes will be no different to those in other classes in terms of not having any separate or additional provisions put into place from other classes in the event of staff illness, absences or whole school events such as school visits, parish liturgy etc.

From year to year, the allocation of teachers to classes is focused on the needs of the whole school, and consequently the school cannot guarantee long term continuity or predictability with regard to teaching staff.

Parental involvement

It is a key requirement of the school that parents/guardians must commit to attend meetings with the SSLD class teacher and SLT as required during the school year. Parents are also required to attend at least 2 SLT sessions per month so as to help their child make progress with their speech and language development while in the class.

Communication between teacher/SLT and parents is encouraged from the outset and where any classroom issues arise they are dealt with jointly (by parents and SSLD Class staff).

Parents/guardians are required to be involved with setting speech and language goals and implementing speech and language therapy programmes in the home while their child is attending the class. This home support is of great value to the child and also to parents.

Parental support is essential to ensure that a child benefits fully from his/her limited time in the class.

Placement Reviews

Placement in the SSLD Class is for a maximum of two years.

The pupil's progress will be monitored throughout each year, and the SSLD Class Teacher and the SLT will give feedback to parents/guardians at regular individual meetings.

The SSLD Class staff, in consultation with parents/guardians, may carry out a review regarding suitability of placement. Parental engagement with SLT and teacher during the course of the year will be among the factors taken into consideration as part of any review.

Discharge from the SSLD Class

A child may be discharged from the SSLD Class following a one or two year placement when any or some of the following apply:

- The child has come to the end of the two year period of attendance
- The child has reached the upper class age limit for attendance in the SSLD Class

- The SSLD Class team consider the pupil able to return to mainstream education
- The SSLD Class team no longer considers the SSLD Class as the most suitable placement for the child's educational development
- The parents/guardian of the child request transfer from the SSLD Class

Prior to discharge from the SSLD Class speech and language and academic assessments will be carried out and reports forwarded to the relevant parties. The SSLD Class staff will give feedback on the assessment results and recommendations to parents/guardians on the pupil's discharge.

Transition to Mainstream/Other Educational Placement

Towards the end of their time in the SSLD Class pupils will have comprehensive Speech and Language reassessments carried out with them. Reports on these assessments will include recommendations for any support they may need on their return to mainstream or other educational placements. The parents/guardians are encouraged to visit the school to which their child is transferring to ensure there will be appropriate support provided there for their child.

SSLD Class teacher and SLT liaise with staff and other professionals involved in the child's next educational placement prior to the child's transition there. Children visit their next school placement prior to transferring there full time.

Teachers/Principal from the child's next school placement are encouraged to visit the child in the SSLD Class setting to get a sense of how the class operates and how the child functions with the SSLD class setting.

The SLT from the SSLD Class will visit pupils in their new school one to two months after the child has started there to allow time for the child to settle there. At this time, SLT provides advice and school programmes to teaching and support staff if appropriate.

School Transport

In general, a child who is eligible for placement in a SSLD class is on the basis of DES criteria or spare capacity provision, also eligible for free transport to the SSLD class assigned by the AAC, subject to the terms of the School Transport Scheme.

The Schools Transport Service facilitates the children attending this class in the same manner as children attending other Special Classes/Schools.

It is a parent's responsibility to ensure that a child is ready for collection at the agreed time in the morning and that there is someone to receive the child on return home in the evening.

Implementation

This policy is effective immediately.

Ratification & Communication

This policy was ratified by the Chairperson of the Board of Management in October 2019 and reviewed annually.

Review Timetable

This policy will be reviewed in September 2022.

Evaluation

This policy is monitored on an ongoing basis.

Ms. Natasha Bassett

Natasha Bassett

(Principal)

Prof. Anne Looney

Anne Looney

(Chairperson)

Date: November 2021

Appendix 6

St Patrick's B.N.S, Drumcondra, Dublin 9, D09H008

Scoil Phádraig, Droim Conrach, Áth Cliath

Telephone 018372714 email: saintpatricksbns@gmail.com

FOR SCHOOL YEAR SEPT .....

APPLICATION FOR ENROLMENT (PLEASE USE BLOCK CAPITALS) ALL SECTIONS MUST BE COMPLETED

SECTION A: CHILD

Surname ..... PPS:.....

First Name(s) .....

Date of Birth .....

Does child have a brother in this school ☐ YES ☐ NO

SECTION B: PARENTS/GUARDIANS

Names .....

……..

Address .....

……

……

Email address: ……....

Telephone Nos:

Parent /Guardian1: ……

Parent/ Guardian 2: ……

SECTION C:

Has the child attended any other school? 🕊 YES 🕊 NO

If *YES* please state in respect of last school attended

(a) Name and address of school .....

…….....

……

(b) Class level in which the child was in the school .....

Signature of Parent/Guardian ..... Date .....